
DR. ABUBAKER ABDUL RAHMAN SHAFFI AL MADANI

MD (Gothenburg) · FRCPC (Canada)

Consultant Neurologist & Neuromuscular Specialist

Head, Department of Neurology — Rashid Hospital

Adjunct Clinical Associate Professor — Mohammed Bin Rashid University of Medicine and Health Sciences

Vice President — Emirates Neurology Society (EMINS)

Email: aasalmadani@dubaihealth.ae · DHA Sheryan Licence: 00061072-001 · Languages: English, Arabic

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Research and academic oriented consultant neurologist with more than fifteen years of continuous national service in the United Arab Emirates. Board-certified by the Royal College of Physicians and Surgeons of Canada and subspecialty-trained in neuromuscular medicine at the University of Toronto. Currently leading the Neurology service at Rashid Hospital, Dubai, UAE. National and regional leadership roles include Vice-Presidency of the Emirates Neurology Society (EMINS), Congress Presidency of the 3rd Dubai Neurology Congress (2023), and chief organising roles in relevant regional conferences.

EDUCATION & POSTGRADUATE TRAINING

- **MD (Doctor of Medicine)** — University of Gothenburg, Sweden, 1997.
- **Residency in Neurology** — University of Toronto, Canada (ranked #1 in Canada by the Royal College of Canada and #4 in North America by the American Academy of Neurology).
- **Fellowship in Neuromuscular Disease (2 years)** — University of Toronto, Canada.
- **FRCPC — Fellow of the Royal College of Physicians and Surgeons of Canada in Neurology**, 2009.

CLINICAL APPOINTMENTS

- **Head of Department & Consultant Neurologist** — Department of Neurology, Rashid Hospital, Dubai Health (DHA), Dubai, UAE (2011 – present).
- **Consultant Neurologist** — Department of Neurology, Rashid Hospital, Dubai Health (DHA), Dubai, UAE (2009 – 2011).
- **Consultant Neurologist & Neuromuscular Specialist** — Mediclinic City Hospital, Dubai Healthcare City, Dubai, UAE (2011 – present).
- **Consultant Neurologist** — United Medical Center, Wafi, Dubai, UAE (2013 – present).

ORGANISATIONAL & LEADERSHIP ROLES

- **Head, Department of Neurology — Rashid Hospital:** leadership of the largest neurology department in the UAE (approximately 30 neurologists).
- **Head, Neurophysiology and Neuromuscular Services — Dubai Academic Health Corporation (DAHC).**
- **Vice President — Emirates Neurology Society (EMINS):** coordinating regional and international academic meetings and the monthly Dubai Neurology Forum case discussion (since 2012).
- **Co-developer of the Rashid Hospital Stroke Programme,** subsequently accredited by the German Stroke Society — the only stroke unit certified by the German Stroke Society outside the European Union.
- **Founder, the first state-of-the-art Multiple Sclerosis Centre in the UAE at Rashid Hospital.**
- **Founder, Multidisciplinary Headache Service — Dubai Health,** extending specialist care to Al Barsha and Nad Al Hamar Primary Health Centres.
- **Chairman, Myasthenia Gravis UAE Chapter.**
- **Chairman, UAE Headache Chapter.**
- **Vice-President, Main Organiser, Chair and Speaker — 24th World Congress of Neurology (WCN 2019),** Dubai, 27–31 October 2019.
- **Chairman & Chief Organiser — 1st MENA Neuromuscular Conference, Abu Dhabi (2019).**
- **Chairman & Chief Organiser — 1st MENA Headache Conference, Dubai (2015).** The series has since spread across the MENA region, with subsequent meetings in Antalya, Istanbul, Morocco, and Egypt; the 9th meeting was held in Istanbul.
- **Member, Organising Committee — 1st, 2nd, and 3rd MENA Stroke Conference.**
- **Chairman, Scientific Committee — Abu Dhabi Brain Conference, 6th Arab Pediatrics Conference, and the EMINS Virtual Congress 2021** (more than 16,500 delegates worldwide, 21 CME credits).
- **Congress President — 3rd Dubai Neurology Congress (24–26 February 2023),** endorsed by EMINS and the World Federation of Neurology, hosting Prof. Christian Lampl, then sitting President of the European Headache Federation, as featured speaker.
- **Chair of Clinical Practice Guideline committees** for Headache, Epilepsy and Neuropathy.
- **Organiser of Multiple Sclerosis, Epilepsy, Parkinson's Disease, and Dementia awareness programmes** at hospital, DAHC, and Dubai level.

TEACHING & ACADEMIC ACTIVITIES

- **Adjunct Clinical Associate Professor of Neurology, Mohammed Bin Rashid University of Medicine and Health Sciences (MBRU), Dubai —** since 2019.
- **Active teaching faculty for the Rashid Hospital Neurology Residency Programme** since its inception in Dubai Academic Health Corporation (DAHC) in 2012.

- Teaching of medical students, residents, and interns at Dubai Medical College.
- Teaching at the University of Sharjah.
- Dedicated teaching courses delivered in headache, polyneuropathy, and Parkinson's disorders, and in neurophysiology and neuromuscular disorders for residents and specialist physicians.
- Lecture series for Primary Health Care (PHC) — ongoing.
- Lectures delivered to Rheumatologists and Orthopaedic specialists.
- Telemedicine teaching at international level — targeting neurologists, residents, and medical students.
- Renowned speaker at regional and international neurology conferences.
- Academic leadership within EMINS — updating knowledge of neurologists across the UAE through regional and international academic meetings, and coordinating the Dubai Neurology Forum monthly case discussion since 2012.
- Neuroanatomy teaching series (2002–2003) and CME programme coordinator during residency at the University of Toronto.

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS (selection)

1. Bohlega S, Inshasi J, Al Tahan AR, Madani AB, Qahtani H, Rieckmann P. Multiple sclerosis in the Arabian Gulf countries: a consensus statement. *J Neurol*. 2013;260(12):2959–2963. PMID: [23504049](#).
2. Hashim H, Zeb-un-Nisa, Alrukn SAM, Al Madani AAR. Drug resistant neuroleptic malignant syndrome and the role of electroconvulsive therapy. *J Pak Med Assoc*. 2014;64(4):471–473. PMID: [24864649](#).
3. Alboudi A, Sarathchandran P, Alrukn S, Al Madani A. Cerebral venous thrombosis presenting with subdural haematoma as first presentation for systemic lupus erythematosus with negative antiphospholipid antibodies. *BMJ Case Rep*. 2014;2014:bcr2014205355. PMID: [25080548](#).
4. Sarathchandran P, Al Madani A, Alboudi AM, Inshasi J. Mycoplasma pneumoniae infection presenting as stroke and meningoencephalitis with aortic and subclavian aneurysms without pulmonary involvement. *BMJ Case Rep*. 2018;2018:bcr2017221831. [doi:10.1136/bcr-2017-221831](#).
5. Sarathchandran P, Alboudi A, AlSuwaidi R, Almadani AAR. Iatrogenic transverse myelitis in a patient with rheumatoid arthritis. *BMJ Case Rep*. 2019;12(3):e227584. PMID: [30898959](#).
6. Jumah MA, Muhaizea MA, Rumayyan AA, Saman AA, Shehri AA, Cupler E, Jan M, Madani AA, et al. Current management of Duchenne muscular dystrophy in the Middle East: expert report. *Neurodegener Dis Manag*. 2019;9(3):123–133. PMID: [31166138](#).
7. Inshasi JS, Almadani A, Al Fahad S, Noori SI, Alsaadi T, Shakra M, Shatila AO, Zein TM, Boshra A. High-efficacy therapies for relapsing-remitting multiple sclerosis: implications for adherence. An expert opinion from the United Arab Emirates. *Neurodegener Dis Manag*. 2020;10(4):257–266. PMID: [32438857](#).
8. Kamal YM, Abdelmajid Y, Al Madani AAR. Cerebrospinal fluid confirmed COVID-19-associated encephalitis treated successfully. *BMJ Case Rep*. 2020;13(9):e237378. PMID: [32938656](#).
9. Khan M, Al Madani A, Habboush S, Abdulla M, Al Basti AK, Villanueva MJ, Goadsby PJ, Kamal Y. Multidisciplinary headache clinic — impact of a new model for headache care in Dubai. *Clin Neurol Neurosurg*. 2021;208:106845. PMID: [34352629](#).

10. Alsaadi T, Noori S, Varakian R, Youssef S, Almadani A. Real-world experience of erenumab in patients with chronic or episodic migraine in the UAE. *BMC Neurol.* 2022;22(1):221. PMID: [35710354](#).
11. Al Shehri A, Al-Asmi A, Al Salti AM, Almadani A, Hassan A, Bamaga AK, Cupler EJ, Al-Hashel J, Alabdali MM, Alanazy MH, Noori S. A Multidisciplinary Perspective Addressing the Diagnostic Challenges of Late-Onset Pompe Disease in the Arabian Peninsula Region Developed From an Expert Group Meeting. *J Neuromuscul Dis.* 2022;9(5):661–673. PMID: [35754286](#).
12. Inshasi J, Farouk S, Shatila A, Hassan A, Szolics M, Thakre M, Kayed D, Krieger D, Almadani A, Alsaadi T, Benedetti B, Mifsud V, Jacob A, Sayegh S, Boshra A, Alroughani R. Multicentre Observational Study of Treatment Satisfaction with Cladribine Tablets in the Management of Relapsing Multiple Sclerosis in the Arabian Gulf: The CLUE Study. *Neurol Ther.* 2023;12(4):1309–1318. PMID: [37289421](#).
13. Alsaadi T, Kayed DM, Al-Madani A, Hassan AM, Terruzzi A, Krieger D, Riachi N, Sarathchandran P, Al-Rukn S. Consensus-Based Recommendations on the Use of CGRP-Based Therapies for Migraine Prevention in the UAE. *Neurol Ther.* 2023;12(6):1845–1865. PMID: [37792218](#).
14. Alsuwaidi S, Kamalboor H, Khairi T, Almadani A. Anti-Ma2 encephalitis in a phenotypic female with XY gonadal dysgenesis: A case report. *Epilepsy Behav Rep.* 2023;24:100623. PMID: [37854277](#).
15. Alsaadi T, Kayed DM, Al-Madani A, Hassan AM, Krieger D, Riachi N, Sarathchandran P, Al-Rukn S. Acute Treatment of Migraine: Expert Consensus Statements from the United Arab Emirates (UAE). *Neurol Ther.* 2024;13(2):257–281. [doi:10.1007/s40120-023-00576-4](#).
16. Albilali A, Al-Hashel J, Elchami Z, Almadani A, et al. Unmet Needs of Patients Living with Migraine in the Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) Countries. *Pain Ther.* 2024;13(2):201–210. [doi:10.1007/s40122-024-00576-8](#).
17. Iltaf-Mairajuddin S, Channa R, Shaffi Al Madani AAR, Inshasi JS, Perkash J, Kamran SHU. An Unusual Presentation of the Cervicobrachial Variant of Guillain-Barré Syndrome in a 32-Year-Old Previously Healthy Male. *Cureus.* 2024;16(2):e53610. PMID: [38449933](#).
18. Iltaf Mairajuddin S, Inshasi JSS, Channa R, Siddiqi SA, Al Madani AARS, Flayyih R. A Rare and Challenging Presentation of Acute Hemorrhagic Leukoencephalitis With Tumefactive Demyelinating Lesions in a 41-Year-Old Male. *Cureus.* 2024;16(4):e58282. [doi:10.7759/cureus.58282](#).
19. Terruzzi A, AlMadani A, Al-Rukn S, Farghaly M, Dallal SA, Zayed M, Vainstein N, Fathy M, Uboweja A, Natarajan A, Subramanyam K, Ramachandrachar BC, Aljabban A. A Retrospective Analysis of Disease Epidemiology, Comorbidity Burden, Treatment Patterns, and Healthcare Resource Utilization of Migraine in the United Arab Emirates. *Pain Ther.* 2024;13(5):1235–1255. PMID: [39030417](#).
20. Bevilacqua JA, Al-Salti AM, Al Madani A, Alves da Fonseca A, Durmus H, Chai J, Alshehri A, Ribeiro MG, Sgobbi P, Nikitin SS, Vargas S, Furtado A, Thibault N, Araujo R, Daba N. Detection of gene variants associated with recessive limb-girdle muscular weakness and Pompe disease in a global cohort of patients through the application of next-generation sequencing analysis. *Front Genet.* 2024;15:1477291. PMID: [39678382](#).
21. Alsaadi T, Al Madani A, Alhatou M, Nada M, Albilali A, Al-Qassabi A, Mohamed H, Mohamed H, El Masry R, Saifuddin GA, AlRukn SA. Prevalence, Treatment, and Unmet Needs of Migraine in the Middle East: A Systematic Review. *Pain Ther.* 2025;14(1):145–183. PMID: [39738973](#).
22. Alshehri AM, Alanazy MH, Alabdali M, Abuzinadah AR, Alshareef A, Abulaban A, AlRoughani RA, et al. (Almadani A among co-authors). Consensus guidelines on the diagnosis and management of myasthenia gravis by the Saudi Arabia Neuromuscular and Electrophysiology Medicine and neuromuscular specialists

from the Gulf Cooperation Council region. *Ther Adv Neurol Disord.* 2025;18:17562864251346333. PMID: [40584517](#).

23. Alsaadi T, Almadani A, AlRuKn S, Hassan A, Sarathchandran P, Shatila A, Szolics M, Benito D, Ince S, Krieger DW. Expert Guidance on Cognitive Impairment in Alzheimer's Disease: A Practical Seven-Step Approach from the United Arab Emirates. *Neurol Ther.* 2025;14(6):2507–2535. PMID: [41045350](#).
24. Siddiqi SA, Almadani A, Rabeeah F, Khan M. Prevalence and factors associated with primary headache disorders among Emirati population in Dubai, United Arab Emirates: A cross-sectional study. *Headache.* 2026 Feb 5 [Epub ahead of print]. PMID: [41641980](#).

Full list of citations on Google Scholar:

URL: <https://scholar.google.com/citations?user=OtnKN8kAAAAJ&hl=en>

SELECTED CONFERENCE ABSTRACTS & POSTER PRESENTATIONS

- Inshasi J, Almadani A, AlruKn S, Abdool S, Alboudi A. Intracranial Germinoma: Very rare mimicker of multiple sclerosis. *Multiple Sclerosis and Related Disorders.* 2014;3(6):745.
- Inshasi J, Almadani A, AlruKn S, Alboudi A. Fingolimod (Gilenya) may improve the chances of conception in women with multiple sclerosis associated with secondary infertility. *Multiple Sclerosis and Related Disorders.* 2014;3(6):749–750.
- Almadani A, Alboudi A, AlruKn S, Sarathchandran P, Inshasi J. Recurrent Guillain Barré Syndrome — a report of three cases with clinical, electrophysiological and CSF profile (P2.070). *Neurology.* 2015;84(14 Supplement).
- Alboudi A, Almadani A, Inshasi J, AlruKn S, Abdool S, Sarathchandran P. Rescue treatment in Guillain Barré syndrome: is it useful? (P3.160). *Neurology.* 2015;84(14 Supplement).
- Inshasi J, Sarathchandran P, Almadani A, AlruKn S, Alboudi A. Mycoplasma pneumoniae infection presenting as stroke and meningoencephalitis (P5.122). *Neurology.* 2015;84(14 Supplement).
- Hashim H, Almadani A. Unique MRI brain imaging findings in patient with bulbar onset amyotrophic lateral sclerosis: A case report. *J Neurol Sci.* 2013;333:e436.
- Hashim H, AlruKn S, Almadani A. Extensive cerebral sinus thrombosis involving bilateral internal jugular, sagittal, sigmoid and transverse sinuses with clinical presentation of subarachnoid haemorrhage. *J Neurol Sci.* 2013;333:e201.
- Malik Y, Dar JA, Almadani AAR. Seizures with an atypical aetiology in an elderly patient: Eagle's syndrome — how does one treat it? *BMJ Case Reports.* 2015;bcr2014206136.
- Malik YM, Almadani AA, Dar JA. Can a stroke present with flexor spasms? A highly rare experience. *GMS German Medical Science.* 2014;12.
- Inshasi J, Sarathchandran P, Thakre MC, Al Talai, Al Suwaidi R, Al Madani A. Oral Cladribine is Effective in the Treatment of Tumefactive Demyelination in Relapsing Remitting Multiple Sclerosis — A Case Report. *The Open Neurology Journal.* 2020;14(1).

- Inshasi JS, Yamout B, Farghali M, Sara Ahmad MA, Alcharif R, Almadani A, et al. Budget Impact Analysis for Introduction of Cladribine Tablets As a Treatment for High Disease Active Relapsing Multiple Sclerosis in UAE (POSC96). Value in Health. 2022.
- Malik YM, Karmastaji SM, AlJarman KK, Abdelmajid YA, Lootah MH, Dar JA, Almadani AAR. Paradigm shift in migraine management impacted by COVID-19 pandemic and the role of confounding factors inflicting the change. Neurosciences Journal. 2022;27(3):156–163.
- Sarathchandran P, Inshasi JSS, Alboudi A, Almadani A. Rare clinical syndromes in relapsing-remitting multiple sclerosis — the useless hand syndrome and restless genital syndrome. Multiple Sclerosis Journal. 2016;22(6):NP10–NP11.
- World Congress of Neurology (WCN 2019), Dubai: poster presentations including Multidisciplinary headache clinic; Trigeminal Neuralgia and other autonomic cephalgias; State of the art treatment of immune neuropathies; Axonal versus demyelination electrophysiology; Genetic determinants of various epilepsy types in the Emirati population; Fragile X-associated tremor/ataxia syndrome masquerading as NPH; Neuropathy etiological factors; Autoimmune limbic encephalitis clinical profile; Status epilepticus in intracranial hypotension.
- Almadani A, Malik Y, Dar JA. Can atherosclerosis be one of the causes of anterior spinal artery thrombosis? J Ayub Med Coll Abbottabad. 2012;24(2):158–159.

ACTIVE RESEARCH PROJECTS & INITIATIVES

- Genetic determinants of idiopathic epilepsy in the Arabic population.
- Bariatric surgery and its neurological complications in the UAE population.
- Experience of thrombolysis in the UAE.
- Prevalence of migraine in the DHA population and impact of profession.
- Effect on clinical parameters of migraine after sphenopalatine ganglion block in the acute state.
- Headache registry — Rashid Hospital.
- Multiple Sclerosis registry — Rashid Hospital.
- Myasthenia Gravis registry.
- Movement Disorder registry.
- Headache patient management through peripheral health clinics and telemedicine — outcomes evaluation.
- MENACTRIMS certification for the MS Centre at Rashid Hospital.
- UAE guidelines for the treatment of Myasthenia Gravis.
- UAE guidelines for the treatment of Alzheimer's disease.

INVESTIGATOR ROLES IN CLINICAL STUDIES

- CONSONANCE Study (Ocrelizumab in Primary Progressive Multiple Sclerosis) — site approved by Ethics Committee; 6 patients enrolled. Investigator.

- CLUE Study — Evaluation of treatment satisfaction with Cladribine tablets in relapsing-remitting multiple sclerosis patients. Investigator. (Results published as Inshasi J et al., Neurol Ther 2023;12(4):1309–1318. PMID 37289421.)

MEDICAL & SCIENTIFIC SOCIETIES

- Vice President — Emirates Neurology Society (EMINS).
- Adjunct Clinical Associate Professor — Mohammed Bin Rashid University of Medicine and Health Sciences (MBRU).
- Chairman — Myasthenia Gravis UAE Chapter.
- Chairman — UAE Headache Chapter.
- Active Fellow — Royal College of Physicians and Surgeons of Canada.
- Member — American Academy of Neurology.
- Member — American Neurological Association.
- Member — Canadian Neurological Society.
- Member — Canadian Society of Neuromuscular Diseases.
- Member — Emirates Medical Society.
- Member — European Headache Society.

OFFICIAL COMMITTEE MEMBERSHIPS

- Member — Committee for Quality Improvement, Rashid Hospital.
- Member — Committee for Risk Management, Rashid Hospital.
- Member — Higher Committee for Medico-Legal Cases.
- Member — Higher Committee for Legal Affairs.
- Member — Higher Committee for Medical Liability.
- Member — Higher Committee for Retirement.

SELECTED CONFERENCES (ATTENDED, CHAIRED, OR FACULTY)

- **American Academy of Neurology Annual Meeting (USA)** — regular attendance and abstract presentations.
- **European Committee for Treatment and Research in Multiple Sclerosis (ECTRIMS)** — annual attendance.
- **Emirates League Against Epilepsy** — active participant.
- **24th World Congress of Neurology (WCN 2019)**, Dubai, 27–31 October 2019 — Vice-President, Main Organiser, Chair, and Speaker.
- **1st MENA Neuromuscular Conference (2019)**, Abu Dhabi — Chairman and Chief Organiser.

- **1st MENA Headache Conference (2015)**, Dubai — Chairman and Chief Organiser. The series has subsequently been held across the MENA region — Antalya, Istanbul, Morocco, and Egypt — reaching its 9th MENA meeting in Istanbul.
- **Global Migraine and Pain Summit / 4th MENA / 2nd Turkish-African Headache and Pain Management Meeting (28–30 October 2020)** — Speaker, plenary lecture: "Choosing the efficient acute treatment for migraine." Workshop faculty on regional differences in headache education.
- **5th MENA Meeting (28–30 October 2021), Antalya** — Scientific Committee Member, alongside Prof. Peter Goadsby, Prof. Messoud Ashina, Prof. Cristina Tassorelli, Prof. Stefan Evers, Prof. Timothy Steiner, and Prof. Zaza Katsarava.
- **3rd Dubai Neurology Congress (24–26 February 2023)** — Congress President. Endorsed by EMINS and the World Federation of Neurology. Hosted Prof. Christian Lampl, sitting President of the European Headache Federation, as featured speaker.
- **2nd GCC Headache and Pain Summit (3–4 June 2023)**, Dubai — Speaker, alongside the full EHF leadership trio (Lampl, Maassen van den Brink, Sacco).
- **Emirates Neurology Society Virtual Congress (4–6 February 2021)** — Chairman, Scientific Committee. More than 16,500 delegates worldwide; 21 CME credits.
- **Abu Dhabi Brain Conference** — Chairman, Scientific Committee.
- **6th Arab Pediatrics Conference** — Chairman, Scientific Committee.
- **5th Dubai Neurology Congress 2025** — Moderator.
- **22nd Emirates Critical Care Conference (8–10 May 2026)** — Faculty.
- **PAIRS 2025 (Pan Arab Interventional Radiology Society)** — Faculty.
- **1st GCC Headache and Pain Summit (3–4 June 2022)**, Address Dubai Marina Hotel — host and summit ambassador (official welcome videos in English and Arabic).
- **1st, 2nd, and 3rd MENA Stroke Conference** — Member of the Organising Committee.
- **MENA-ECTRIMS 2016, Amman** — participant.
- **3rd East Mediterranean and 5th UAE Joint Epilepsy Congress 2016**
- **2nd Middle East Camp for Parkinson's Disease, Movement Disorder and Neuromodulation**, Dubai.
- **Multiple Sclerosis Symposium 2014**, Dubai, 4–5 April 2014.
- **International Conference on Alpha-Synuclein in Parkinson's Disease and Related Neurodegenerative Diseases 2013**, Dubai, 1–3 March 2013.
- **GCC MS and Headache Society (2022); Pan-Arab Congress (2022)** — member.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built and now leads the largest neurology service in the United Arab Emirates, caring for more than 20,000 patients annually.

- Co-developed the Rashid Hospital Stroke Programme, accredited by the German Stroke Society and the American Stroke Society.
- Initiated, with team, the Neurology Residency Programme and teaching culture within Dubai Health, a direct contributor to the Emiratisation of specialty medicine.
- Established the research culture within Dubai Health Neurology, with active disease registries in MS, neuropathy, headache, movement disorders, and epilepsy.
- Initiated specialist sub-specialties within the Department (MS, neuromuscular, headache, epilepsy, movement disorders).
- Founded Dubai Health's multidisciplinary headache service.
- Contributing reviewer to the UAE's first national Multiple Sclerosis treatment guidelines (2024), now integrated into the DHA's Multiple Sclerosis Ejadah Programme.
- Co-author of the UAE national framework on Alzheimer's disease and cognitive impairment (2025, Neurology and Therapy).
- Active cross-institutional collaboration with national, regional, and international centres of excellence.

FUTURE STRATEGIC DIRECTION

- Establishing fellowship programmes in Neuromuscular Medicine, Epilepsy, Multiple Sclerosis, and Stroke at Rashid Hospital.
- Establishing a comprehensive Neuroscience Centre for the United Arab Emirates.